

Northwind Robotics

Employee Handbook — 2025 Edition (Excerpt)

1. Company Overview

Northwind Robotics, Inc. was founded in 2014 and is headquartered in Portland, Oregon. The company designs autonomous warehouse robots and the fleet-management software that coordinates them. As of January 2025, Northwind employs 1,240 people across four offices: Portland (HQ), Austin, Toronto, and Berlin. The Chief Executive Officer is Dr. Lena Varga, and the company is privately held following its Series D round in 2023.

2. Working Hours and Remote Work

Standard working hours are 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM in the employee's local time zone, with a one-hour unpaid lunch break. Northwind operates a hybrid model: employees are expected to be in their assigned office at least two days per week. Fully remote arrangements require Director-level approval and are reviewed annually.

Core collaboration hours, during which all employees should be reachable regardless of location, are 11:00 AM to 3:00 PM Pacific Time.

3. Paid Time Off

Northwind provides paid time off (PTO) that accrues monthly. Accrual rates depend on tenure, as shown below:

Tenure	Annual PTO Days	Monthly Accrual
0–2 years	18 days	1.5 days
3–5 years	24 days	2.0 days
6+ years	30 days	2.5 days

Unused PTO of up to 5 days may be carried into the next calendar year. Any balance above 5 days is forfeited on December 31 unless the employee is based in Berlin, where local law permits carryover of the full balance until March 31.

4. Parental Leave

All employees who have completed at least 12 months of continuous service are eligible for 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave. This applies equally to birth, adoption, and foster placement.

Leave must be taken within 12 months of the qualifying event.

5. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to act with integrity and to avoid conflicts of interest. Any outside employment or consulting that relates to robotics, automation, or logistics software must be disclosed in writing to the Ethics Office before the work begins.

- Confidential information must never be shared outside the company without a signed non-disclosure agreement.
- Gifts from suppliers valued above 75 USD must be declined or reported.
- Harassment of any kind results in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

6. Expense Reimbursement

Business expenses are reimbursed when submitted within 30 days through the Concur system. Receipts are mandatory for any expense above 25 USD. Travel must be booked through the approved corporate travel portal; see the Travel & Expense Policy for class-of-travel rules and per-diem rates.

Questions about this handbook should be directed to the People Operations team at people@northwindrobotics.example.